

Damien GUESDON

HEAD OF IT / EX-CTO

IT Strategy, Budget Optimization, Vendor Management & Post-M&A Harmonization

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Executive with over 20 years of global experience in critical infrastructure management, including a proven track record progressing from Engineering to Chief Technology Officer (CTO). Specialized in driving corporate growth: process rationalization, strategic vendor cost optimization, and post-merger governance (M&A). Having recently completed an MSc in AI Engineering, I approach emerging technologies with pragmatism. My objective is to leverage innovation to secure intellectual property (combating Shadow AI), manage technical debt, and align engineering with the company's strategic and financial vision.

KEY SKILLS

Strategy & Leadership (C-Level):

Aligning IT with business goals, global roadmap execution, leading cross-functional technical departments (18+ staff), driving a culture of profitability.

Vendor & Contract Management:

Strategic competitive bidding, end-to-end procurement strategy, and drastic OPEX/CAPEX reductions.

Operational Excellence:

ITIL/Lean standardization, building CABs, and steering major ISO certifications.

M&A & Transformation:

IT due diligence, harmonization, and integration of complex technological infrastructures.

Data Governance & Sovereign AI:

Designing secure on-premise architectures, business process automation, and preventing data leakage.

LANGUAGES

🇫🇷 French: Native

🇬🇧 English: Fluent (including technical)

🇪🇸 Catalan: In progress

EDUCATION

MSc in AI Engineering, OpenClassrooms, 2026

Rigorous technical engineering curriculum (Data Science & MLOps). Final project personally directed towards IT governance and sovereign architecture.

Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), IT Resource Mgmt, 2005-2006

IT Resource Management Specialist

Higher National Diploma (BTS), Analyst Programmer, CNFDI, 2001

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - Infrastructure - Alphaslink

France - Jan 2024 - May 2025

- M&A & Network Harmonization:** Directed the technical post-merger integration of 4 distinct networks (previous acquisition, historical network, newer VXLAN core, and recent acquisition) into a unified, modern MPLS infrastructure (supporting ADSL/Fiber connectivity for 40,000 physical corporate sites and billions of minutes of VoIP).
- Vendor Management & Strategic Financial Optimization:**
 - Network Merger Project:** Overhauled the procurement strategy against an initial €130M quote (Cisco). Orchestrated competitive bidding (Juniper, Huawei, HP) and rigorously optimized the target architecture, successfully delivering the final project for €2M.
 - Office 365 Licensing:** Conducted a comprehensive capacity audit and contract renegotiation, generating €70K in recurring annual savings (for a scope of 150 employees).
 - Cybersecurity:** Co-negotiated and defined the architecture for a next-generation SOC infrastructure (Palo Alto).
- Governance & Operational Excellence:** Established and chaired the cross-departmental Change Advisory Board (CAB). Implemented strict change management standards, drastically reducing production incidents. Successfully managed and validated the renewal of 4 major ISO certifications (including ISO 27001, 9001, 22301, and HDS).
- Team Leadership:** Directed an 18-person engineering department, restructuring the team into 4 specialized hubs (VoIP, Network, R&D, Datacenter).

Sovereign AI Architect & IT Governance - KISAI (R&D)

Remote - Since June 2025

- Innovation Strategy & POC:** Conceptualized and developed "SophIA," a sovereign B2B AI architecture model. Championed a pragmatic approach providing enterprise-grade AI while keeping data strictly on-premise to eliminate "Shadow AI" risks.
- Thought Leadership:** Authored the technical essay "*SophIA: Assistant suprême?*" to demystify AI models for C-suite executives and translate technical capabilities into actionable corporate governance strategies.

Senior Infrastructure Consultant & Interim IT Director - Freelance / KISAI

France / Remote - 2018 - 2023

- Security & Compliance:** Steered the deployment of resilient foundations enabling strict adherence to security standards (facilitating ISO 27001 and HDS certification renewals).
- Complex Deployments:** Architected and supervised critical infrastructure migrations for ISPs, including SOC environments.
- High-Availability Architecture:** Designed and integrated robust operator backbones and datacenters requiring zero-downtime operational standards.

Technical Director / Senior Consultant - Freelance

La Plaine-sur-Mer - 2011 - 2018

- Deployed and managed operator backbones, datacenters, and MPLS networks.
- Led network engineering and ISP service integrations, focusing on high availability designs.

Previous Experience (SysAdmin & Network)

- 2005 - 2011

- ALPHALINK** (2008-2011): Network Architect - Designed architectures, managed technical projects.
- PYGRAM** (2007-08): Systems & Network Manager (VmWare, TSE).
- Renault / BI-SAM / BNP Paribas** (2005-07): Systems Administrator & IT Support in large-scale enterprise environments.